BALAJI BALARAMAN

DevOps / DevSecOps Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

DevOps / DevSecOps Engineer with 3+ years of experience designing, automating, deploying, and securing cloud-native applications across Azure, AWS, and GCP. Strong Hands-on expertise in CI/CD automation pipeline development, container orchestration (Kubernetes, Docker), infrastructure as code (Terraform), and cloud security hardening. Delivered enterprise-grade fintech and AI-driven platforms with measurable improvements in deployment frequency, release reliability, and compliance posture. Holds active Microsoft AZ-400 and HashiCorp Terraform Associate certifications.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD & DevOps	Jenkins (multi-server, multibranch), GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Nexus, SonarQube, Git, Bitbucket
Cloud – Azure	AKS, Azure Container Apps, ACR, Key Vault, PostgreSQL Flexible Server, Data Factory, Event Grid, Front Door, Application Insights, AI Foundry
Cloud – AWS	EC2, ECS, Lambda, EventBridge, SNS, API Gateway, ELB, NLB, IAM, S3, CloudWatch
Containers & IaC	Docker, Kubernetes (AKS / EKS), Docker Swarm, Docker Compose, Podman, Terraform, Ansible
Monitoring & Logging	ELK Stack (Filebeat, Metricbeat, Heartbeat), Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Dynatrace, Datadog, Azure Application Insights, CloudWatch
Security & DevSecOps	Snyk, Trivy, Grype, Vulnerability Management, OS Patching, Configuration Hardening, Compliance Validation, Least-Privilege IAM, SAST/DAST
Scripting & OS	Shell Scripting, Linux Administration, Python, Java, Groovy
Web & Networking	Nginx, SSL/TLS, Reverse Proxy, VPN, Private Subnets, Kubernetes Ingress, API Gateway

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps / DevSecOps Engineer | *Zuci Systems India Pvt. Ltd.* — Aug 2023 – Present

- Designed and maintained CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins (multi-server, multibranch) and GitHub Actions, enabling automated multi-environment deployments across Azure and AWS and reducing average release cycle time by ~40%.
- Deployed and managed containerized microservices using Docker, Kubernetes (AKS), and Docker Swarm across IaaS, PaaS, and Kubernetes platforms, supporting 3 concurrent enterprise client environments.
- Automated cloud infrastructure provisioning with Terraform, eliminating manual setup errors and standardizing repeatable deployment workflows across dev, staging, and production environments.
- Led DevSecOps remediation program including vulnerability management (Snyk, Trivy, Grype), OS patching, and configuration hardening, achieving zero critical CVEs in production for 3 consecutive quarters.
- Implemented full-stack observability using ELK Stack, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, and Azure Application Insights, reducing mean time to resolution (MTTR) for production incidents by 35%.
- Supported production releases for high-compliance fintech workloads, ensuring 99.9% availability SLA and meeting financial regulatory compliance requirements consistently.

Intern — Java & Cloud | *Zuci Systems India Pvt. Ltd.* — Dec 2022 – Jul 2023

- Undertook a rigorous training program in cloud computing basics, practical Java application development, and Linux administration; produced documentation that is now utilized by over 10 team members for future training sessions.
- Worked with DevOps teams with CI/CD task execution, application deployments, environment setup, and incident troubleshooting, contributing to 5+ deployment cycles.

KEY CLIENT PROJECTS

Northern Arc — Financial Services Platform — *Azure · Jenkins · Docker · Kubernetes · ELK Stack*

Leading Indian NBFC enablement platform connecting lenders and borrowers. Built and secured high-volume fintech infrastructure supporting Paytm, MoneyView, and loan disbursement platforms.

- Built Jenkins multi-server CI/CD pipelines reducing Docker image build-to-deploy time by 50% across 4+ microservices for multi-environment deployments.
- Containerized and deployed microservices using Docker Swarm and Kubernetes with Nginx reverse proxy and SSL termination, achieving zero-downtime rolling deployments.
- Configured Azure Virtual Network with private subnets and secure networking for high-compliance fintech workloads, meeting RBI and IRDAI compliance standards.
- Implemented centralized logging and alerting using ELK Stack (Filebeat, Metricbeat, Heartbeat) for container health, system metrics, and uptime monitoring across 20+ services.
- Performed Azure VM security hardening, OS patching, and vulnerability remediation, reducing attack surface and passing 3 external security audits.

Borderless Access — Agentic AI Platform — *Azure · AKS · Azure Container Apps · Prometheus · Grafana · Loki*

Global market research company building AI-driven platform for automated research workflows on GPU-intensive Azure infrastructure.

- Delivered end-to-end Azure DevOps implementation for production AI/ML workloads on AKS and Azure Container Apps, supporting 5 Agentic AI models in parallel.
- Provisioned and managed GPU-enabled AKS node pools supporting ML inferencing workloads, achieving 99.5% uptime for AI pipeline execution.
- Integrated Azure ACR, Key Vault, PostgreSQL Flexible Server, Data Factory, Event Grid, and AI Foundry into a unified secure AI platform, reducing service integration time by 60%.
- Designed secure networking with VPN, private subnets, API Gateway, Azure Front Door, and Kubernetes Ingress, eliminating public endpoint exposure for all internal services.
- Implemented Loki sidecar logging and Prometheus + Grafana dashboards, providing real-time cluster and application observability for 10+ AI microservices.

Mariner Finance — Enterprise Financial Application — *AWS · EC2 · ECS · Jenkins · GitHub Actions · Lambda*

US-based consumer lending company. Migrated and stabilized cloud-native microservices architecture on AWS with strong DevSecOps and compliance requirements.

- Managed EC2-based Docker microservices and ECS cluster container orchestration for an enterprise financial platform processing thousands of loan applications daily.
- Built CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and GitHub Actions with automated testing, SAST security scanning, and multi-environment deployments, reducing deployment errors by 30%.
- Implemented event-driven architecture using AWS Lambda, EventBridge, and SNS for asynchronous financial processing, handling 10,000+ daily transactions reliably.
- Configured API Gateway, ELB, and NLB for intelligent traffic routing and high availability, maintaining 99.95% uptime for consumer-facing financial services.
- Managed AMI creation, EBS snapshots, and backup strategies, achieving RPO of 1 hour and RTO of 2 hours for disaster recovery scenarios.
- Executed OS upgrades, security patching, and DevSecOps vulnerability remediation validated using AWS CLI and security scan re-validation, meeting PCI-DSS requirements.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certification	Issuer	Valid Until
Azure DevOps Engineer Expert (AZ-400)	Microsoft	November 2026
Azure Developer Associate (AZ-204)	Microsoft	March 2026
HashiCorp Terraform Associate (003)	HashiCorp	November 2026

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) | Anna University, Tamil Nadu 2019 – 2023 | First Class